

2과 방에 책상이 있어요

Chapter 2 — There is a desk in the room

This chapter at a glance

주제	Topic 사물 — objects and things
어휘와 문법	Vocabulary & grammar 일상생활 사물, 장소① / 명이·가 / 명에 있어요 — everyday objects and places · the subject marker · saying where something is
활동	Activities 방 안 물건 이름 말하기, 집 관련 정보 읽기 — naming things in a room; reading a housing notice
문화와 정보	Culture & information 한국인의 이름 — Korean names

The chapter title 방에 책상이 있어요 already contains both grammar points you are about to learn: 에 marks where something is (방에 = in the room), and 이 marks what exists (책상이). Read it as "in the room, a desk exists" and the Korean word order stops feeling backwards.

있어요 and 없어요 are the two verbs this whole chapter turns on: 있어요 = there is / I have, 없어요 = there is not / I don't have. They are not opposites formed with a negative word — 없어요 is its own verb, so learn it as a separate item.

도입

Warm-up

Look at the pictures and talk about them

여기는 어디예요?

Where is this place?

여러분 교실에 뭐가 있어요?

What is in your classroom?

The original page shows three scenes: a man sitting on a bed in a dormitory room with a desk, chair, laptop and television; a kitchen with a large refrigerator and a dining table; and a classroom with a map on the wall, a teacher at the front and students at desks. Each is a place whose name you will learn on the next page.

여기 = here, 어디 = where. 여기는 어디예요? is the natural way to ask "where am I?" or "what is this place?" — you met 예요 in chapter 1, so this question is built from grammar you already have.

뭐가 있어요? = "what is there?" Try answering with just a noun plus 있어요 — 책상이 있어요, 의자가 있어요. You do not need a full sentence to be understood.

어휘와 문법 1

Vocabulary & grammar 1

여기는 어디예요? 이게 뭐예요?

Where is this place? What is this?

장소 — Places

회사

company, office

기숙사

dormitory

학교

school

교실

classroom

기숙사 — In the dormitory room

침대

bed

시계

clock

책상

desk

의자

chair

컴퓨터

computer

휴대 전화

mobile phone

교실 — In the classroom

칠판

blackboard

지도

map

책

book

볼펜

ballpoint pen

필통

pencil case

책상

desk

Ask and answer

가 여기는 어디예요?

Where is this place?

나 기숙사예요.

It's a dormitory.

가 이게 뭐예요?

What is this?

나 침대예요.

It's a bed.

이게 is a contraction of 이것이 ("this thing"), and it is what people actually say. 이게 뭐예요? is the single most useful question for a beginner in Korea — point at anything and ask it.

휴대 전화 is literally "carry-around telephone". In speech you will also hear 핸드폰 and simply 폰; all three mean the same thing, but 휴대 전화 is the form used in textbooks and official writing.

Notice 책 (book), 책상 (desk) and 칠판 (blackboard). 책상 is 책 + 상 (table) — a "book table". Korean builds many words this way, so a word you don't know is often two words you do.

명이/가

Noun + 이/가 — the subject marker

문장의 주어를 나타낼 때 사용해요.

Use it to mark the subject of a sentence.

예문 — Examples

가 가방이 있어요?

Is there a bag?

나 네, 가방이 있어요.

Yes, there is a bag.

가 컴퓨터가 있어요?

Is there a computer?

나 네, 컴퓨터가 있어요.

Yes, there is a computer.

가 책이 있어요?

Is there a book?

나 아니요, 책이 없어요.

No, there is no book.

Which marker do I use?

이 after a final consonant (받침)

책상 → 책상이 · 가방 → 가방이

가 after a vowel

지도 → 지도가 · 의자 → 의자가

Same sound rule you met in chapter 1 with 이에요/예요 and 은/는: consonant ending takes 이, vowel ending takes 가. Three different markers, one rule — once you can hear whether a word ends in a 받침, all of them follow.

은/는 and 이/가 both attach to nouns and are easy to confuse. 은/는 introduces what the sentence is about (저는 후엔이에요 — as for me, I'm Huyen). 이/가 marks the thing that exists or acts, which is why 있어요 and 없어요 take it. For now: with 있어요/없어요, use 이/가.

있어요 covers both "there is" and "I have" — 가방이 있어요 can mean "there is a bag" or "I have a bag" depending on the situation. Korean does not need a separate verb for possession.

연습 1 — 교실이에요. 뭐가 있어요?

가 우산이 있어요?

Is there an umbrella?

나 네, 우산이 있어요.

Yes, there is an umbrella.

가 시계가 있어요?

Is there a clock?

나 아니요, 시계가 없어요.

No, there is no clock.

1) 책상, 가방

desk, bag

2) 지도, 모자

map, hat

3) 공책, 휴대 전화

notebook, mobile phone

여러분 교실에 뭐가 있어요? 뭐가 없어요? 친구와 이야기해 보세요.

What is in your classroom? What is not? Talk about it with a classmate.

어휘와 문법 2

Vocabulary & grammar 2

여기는 어디예요? 뭐가 있어요?

Where is this place? What is there?

집 — Rooms in a home

화장실

bathroom

거실

living room

부엌

kitchen

화장실 — In the bathroom

거울

mirror

수건

towel

휴지

toilet paper

거실 · 부엌 — In the living room and kitchen

시계

clock

에어컨

air conditioner

소파

sofa

식탁

dining table

컵

cup

냉장고

refrigerator

Now describe your own home

여러분 집이에요. 뭐가 있어요? 이야기해 보세요.

This is your home. What is there? Try saying it.

냉장고가 있어요. 책상이 있어요.

There is a refrigerator. There is a desk.

화장실 is the room with the toilet, whatever else is in it. Korean bathrooms usually combine toilet, sink and shower in one wet room with a floor drain — which is why there is one word where English needs "bathroom", "toilet" and "washroom".

식탁 is 식 (eating) + 탁 (table) — a table specifically for meals. A desk you work at is 책상. Korean distinguishes tables by what you do at them, so don't translate both as "table".

에어컨, 소파, 컴퓨터 and 컵 are borrowed from English. Once you can read Hangeul, a large slice of household vocabulary is already familiar — but the Korean pronunciation is fixed, so say 에어컨 as it is written, not as "air-con".

부엌 ends in the consonant ㄱ, which is unusual. Before a vowel it links across: 부엌에 is said [부어케]. You will practise exactly this on the pronunciation page at the end of the chapter.

명에 있어요

Noun + 에 있어요 — saying where something is

사람이나 사물이 어디에 있는지 말할 때 사용해요.

Use it to say where a person or thing is.

예문 — Examples

- 가** 텔레비전이 거실에 있어요?
Is the television in the living room?
- 나** 네, 거실에 있어요.
Yes, it's in the living room.
- 가** 시계가 방에 있어요?
Is the clock in the room?
- 나** 네, 방에 있어요.
Yes, it's in the room.
- 가** 후엔 씨가 부엌에 있어요?
Is Huyen in the kitchen?
- 나** 아니요, 방에 있어요.
No, she's in the room.

에 있어요 — attaches to the place

- 방** 방에 있어요
it is in the room
- 거실** 거실에 있어요
it is in the living room
- 학교** 학교에 있어요
he/she is at school
- 기숙사** 기숙사에 있어요
he/she is in the dormitory

에 never changes. Unlike 이/가 and 은/는, there is no consonant-versus-vowel choice to make — 방에, 학교에, 부엌에 all take the same 에. One less rule to remember.

Word order is the reverse of English: the place comes before 있어요, so Korean says "television-SUBJECT living-room-AT exists". English puts the location last; Korean puts it just before the verb. Say the place, then 있어요.

The same 있어요 does two jobs in this chapter: with 이/가 alone it means something exists (책상이 있어요), and with 에 added it says where (방에 책상이 있어요). The chapter title is exactly that full pattern.

에 also marks a person's location, not just an object's — 후엔 씨가 부엌에 있어요 means Huyen is in the kitchen. Note 씨 stays attached to the name before the marker: 후엔 씨가, never 후엔가 씨.

연습 1 — 무엇이 어디에 있어요?

- 가** 거실에 뭐가 있어요?
What is in the living room?

나 거실에 소파가 있어요.

There is a sofa in the living room.

The three practice pictures are a kitchen with a dining table and chairs, a bedroom with a desk, chair, computer and bed, and a bathroom with a mirror and washbasin. Name the room first, then one thing in it.

여러분 집에 뭐가 있어요? 뭐가 없어요? 이야기해 보세요.

What is in your home? What is not? Try saying it.

말하기와 듣기

Speaking & listening

교실에서 라흐만 씨와 이링 씨가 이야기해요. 다음과 같이 이야기해 보세요.

Rahman and Yiling are talking in the classroom. Practise the dialogue below.

라흐만 방에 책상이 있어요?
Is there a desk in your room?

이링 네, 책상이 있어요.
Yes, there is a desk.

라흐만 방에 또 뭐가 있어요?
What else is in the room?

이링 방에 텔레비전이 있어요.
There is a television in the room.

Swap in these pairs

1) 책상 · 텔레비전
desk · television

2) 침대 · 냉장고
bed · refrigerator

또 means "also" or "else", and it goes directly before the question word: 또 뭐가 있어요? = "what else is there?" It is the natural way to keep a conversation going once the first answer lands.

Notice that 이링 answers 네, 책상이 있어요 rather than repeating the whole question. Korean drops whatever is already obvious, so a short answer sounds more natural than a complete sentence here.

여러분 집에 뭐가 있어요? 기숙사에 뭐가 있어요? 이야기해 보세요.

What is in your home? What is in the dormitory? Try saying it.

듣기 — 라민 씨와 고천 씨가 이야기해요

1) 라민 씨 기숙사에 세탁기가 있어요?

1) Is there a washing machine in Ramin's dormitory?

2) 라민 씨 기숙사에 소파가 있어요?

2) Is there a sofa in Ramin's dormitory?

세탁기 (washing machine) has not appeared before. In a listening task you will always meet a word or two you have not studied — listen for 있어요 or 없어요 at the end, which carries the answer, rather than trying to catch every word.

읽기와 쓰기

Reading & writing

다음 글을 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

Read the passage below and answer the questions.

방 있어요! — Room available!

방 1, 거실, 화장실

1 room, living room, bathroom

방에 침대가 있어요. 책상이 있어요.

There is a bed in the room. There is a desk.

하지만 옷장이 없어요.

But there is no wardrobe.

전화: 010-****-****

Phone: 010-****-****

Questions

1) 방에 뭐가 있어요?

1) What is in the room? → 침대가 있어요. 책상이 있어요.

2) 방에 컴퓨터가 있어요?

2) Is there a computer in the room? → 아니요, 없어요 — the notice doesn't mention one.

3) 어떤 방이에요? 고르세요.

3) Which room is it? Choose. The four pictures show a desk, a wardrobe, a room with a bed and desk, and a room with a bed and wardrobe. The notice says there is a bed and a desk but no wardrobe, so the third picture is correct.

Now write your own

방에 침대가 있어요. 그리고 _____

There is a bed in the room. And _____

단어장 — New words

하지만

but, however

옷장

wardrobe

그리고

and, and then

그리고 and 하지만 both join sentences, and both stand at the start of the second sentence rather than between the two. Korean does not put them in the middle the way English uses "and" and "but" — write one sentence, stop, then begin the next with 그리고 or 하지만.

This is a real-world text type: 방 있어요 notices appear on noticeboards, shop windows and online. Learning to read one is the point of the exercise — spot 있어요 for what the room has and 없어요 for what it lacks, and you have understood the offer.

For the writing task, use the pattern from this chapter and join with 그리고: 방에 침대가 있어요. 그리고 책상이 있어요. 그리고 컴퓨터가 있어요. Short sentences joined simply are correct Korean, not a beginner's compromise.

문화와 정보 — 한국인의 이름

Culture & information — Korean names

여러분의 이름은 뭐예요? 한국 사람의 이름은 보통 세 글자예요.

What is your name? Korean names usually have three syllables.

'박민수'라는 사람은 '박'이 성이에요. 성은 가족 이름이에요.

For a person called Park Min-su, 박 is the family name. 성 means family name.

그리고 '민수'는 이름이에요.

And 민수 is the given name.

처음 만나면 '박민수 씨', 또는 '민수 씨'라고 불러요.

When you first meet, you call them 박민수 씨 or 민수 씨.

The parts of a Korean name

성	family name 박 — comes first, usually one syllable
이름	given name 민수 — comes second, usually two syllables
씨	polite address 박민수 씨 or 민수 씨 — never used about yourself

The family name comes first, which is the opposite of English order. 박민수 is Min-su of the Park family — so a document that lists him as "Park Minsu" has not reversed anything.

A small number of family names cover a very large share of the population — 김, 이, 박 alone account for roughly half of all Koreans. That is why 씨 is attached to the full name or the given name, but almost never to the family name alone: 김 씨 is too vague to identify anyone, and sounds abrupt.

Never attach 씨 to your own name. When you introduce yourself, say 저는 민수예요, not 저는 민수 씨예요 — 씨 is respect you give to others, not to yourself.

Questions

1) 한국 사람 '박민수'의 성과 이름은 뭐예요?

1) What is the family name and the given name of 박민수? → 성: 박 · 이름: 민수

2) 한국에서는 이름을 어떻게 불러요?

2) How do people address each other by name in Korea?

3) 여러분 고향에서는 이름을 어떻게 불러요?

3) How are names used in your home country?

The page shows the name in real documents: a business card reading 사장 박민수, a student card for 박수진, an alien registration card for NGUYEN THI HUYEN, and a resident registration card for 김기호. Foreign names on Korean ID keep their own order in Roman letters, so your own card may not follow the Korean pattern.

발음 · 배운 어휘 확인

Pronunciation · Vocabulary checklist

발음 — Listen and repeat

교실에	[교시레] gyo-si-re
없어요	[업씨요] eop-sseo-yo
있어요	[이씨요] i-sseo-yo

교실 + 에 is written 교실에 but said [교시레]: the final ㄹ of 교실 slides onto the following vowel. This is 연음, the same linking you met in chapter 1 with 이름이 → [이르미]. Korean is always spelled by word, never by sound.

없어요 is spelled with two final consonants (ㅃ) but only one is pronounced in place — the ㅃ moves across and doubles, giving [업씨요]. Do not try to say both consonants together; say 업 then 씨.

있어요 works the same way: the doubled ㅃ carries over to give [이씨요]. These two verbs appear in almost every sentence in this chapter, so getting them right now pays off immediately.

Practise

- 1 교실에 책상이 있어요.
There is a desk in the classroom.
- 2 집에 에어컨이 없어요.
There is no air conditioner in the house.
- 가 부엌에 식탁이 있어요?
Is there a dining table in the kitchen?
- 나 네, 부엌에 식탁이 있어요.
Yes, there is a dining table in the kitchen.

배운 어휘 확인 — Vocabulary checklist

회사 company	기숙사 dormitory	책상 desk	의자 chair
침대 bed	컴퓨터 computer	휴대 전화 mobile phone	시계 clock
학교 school	교실 classroom	칠판 blackboard	지도 map
책 book	필통 pencil case	볼펜 ballpoint pen	화장실 bathroom
수건 towel	거울 mirror	휴지 toilet paper	거실 living room
에어컨 air conditioner	소파 sofa	부엌 kitchen	식탁 dining table
컵 cup	냉장고 refrigerator	하지만 but	옷장 wardrobe

그리고
and